BPS Approved Certificate in Clinical Supervision

The British Psychological Society
Approved

Advanced Supervision Skills

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SDS Seminars Ltd

Advanced Clinical Supervision

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Internet Supervision

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Internet Supervision Survey

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What methods are we talking about?

- Skype/Teams/Zoom
- Email
- Messenger / What's App texting
- Messenger / What's App audio/video messages
- Use of viodeo mobile for communication
- Hybrids with face-to-face
- Internet Supervision & Internet Therapy ≠ just Video Conferencing
- Issues relating to one often apply to the other as well
- Internet Supervision a valid form of modelling for the supervisee conducting therapy

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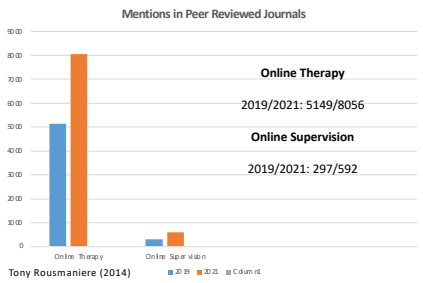

Tony Rousmaniere (2014)

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Issues Pre-Pandemic

- Confidentiality/legality
- Security of platform
- Where's the server?
- No mention of Zoom/Teams. Debate dominated by Skype and Vsee
- Professional body scepticism/concern reflecting general professional scepticism
- Lack of guidance because of unfamiliarity

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Professional Body Positions

- DCP (2014) " Skype or other instant messaging solutions….. a situation where a psychologist did not receive face-to-face and one-to-one supervision with reasonable frequency would not be considered acceptable practise."
- DCP (2020): More detailed document. Regular live video supervision acceptable. Consent for joint sessions/recordings emphasised
- BABCP(2019) "Types of Supervision may be individual, in a CBT Supervision Group, by Skype, Microsoft Messenger or telephone, peer review, or by e-mail (but there should be some direct personal contact on occasions)
- BABCP(2021) Face-to-face supervision……includes using video conferencing
- RCOT (2015) "Skype, email, or other means depending on the supervisee's preferences… is most likely to be used where the practitioner is the only [OT]within a service or locality. This is increasingly happening with the growth of diverse practice and diverse placements for students."
- BACP (2015) "It is considered ethically desirable to receive at least some elements of regular supervision by the same method of communication that is used with clients"
- BACP (2021) **Supervision Competence Framework Document** (resources)

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Professional Body Positions

Professional body positions variable in detail

- UKCP (2012) "Supervision can traditionally take a number of easily identifiable formats: in groups; on a one-to-one basis; by telephone; by internet; in writing, verbally or by videotape and so on"
- UKCP (2021) Detailed advice on internet supervision which 1. Strongly endorses it "If your current supervisor is unwilling or unable to provide supervision for online/remote working, then you will need to seek alternative and/or additional supervision." 2. Highlights safeguarding issues with children and the complexities of international supervision" https://www.psychotherapy.org.uk/media/jrohoner/ukcp-guidelines-for-working-online-or-remotely-v1-0.pdf

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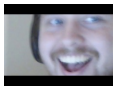
The issues

The setting of internet therapy should mimic the standards/experience of in-the-room work

- WFH (therapist & client)
- Default assumption of one-way viewing



- Visual background
- Lighting / sound
- Personal visual framing and clothing
- Uninterrupted private space
- Background noise
- Checking out comfort regarding disclosure and presence of others ("Who else is in the house")

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The issues

Computer issues

Security:

- Multiple password security. No share access to the machine
- Anti-theft device
- At least daily file backup
- Anti-virus and anti-malware software
- Secure physical storage

Technical issues:

- Familiarity/practice with technology (e.g. dual camera) and the platform
- Checking with client and the importance of client choice
- Two way connection quality
- Plan B in event of technical problems
- Consent on recording

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Confidentiality issues

Video Conferencing Checklist

Survey

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Issues

Internet Therapy ≠ just Video Conferencing

Email Therapy: Social anxiety / ASD clients ? Impulsive clients (ADHD / BPD)

Smart phone videoing: For joint work "in the field"

Audio Files: Alternative learning styles

Between session contact improves outcomes in talking therapies Andersson (2014)

Texting: Alternative learning styles. Sub-culturally acceptable

Between session contact improves outcomes in talking therapies

VARK: https://vark-learn.com/the-vark-questionnaire/

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Impact of technology on supervision process

- Common concerns about interference with subtle non-verbal cues
- Little evidence that video conferencing supervision interferes with the supervisory alliance

  Abbas et al (2011), Rousmaniere & Frederickson (2013)

HOWEVER…

- Zoom fatigue
- Social inhibition (self viewing)
- Speeded up interactions Bateup (2020)
- Tendency to be more didactic Bateup (2020)

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Additional impact of technology on supervisee behaviour

- Can increase supervisee preparation for supervision Sorlie et al (1999)
- Can increases consciousness of expression
- Increases clarity of communication of both the supervisor and supervisee
- Non-visual "instant" methods require more supervisor facilitation and structure (texting/email)
- All "instant group" methods require more supervisor facilitation and structure (Audio, video and texting)
- Written "non-instant" methods encourage more reflection Wright & Griffiths (2010)

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Tips for supervisors

- Behave as if your supervisee is less experienced and confident than you in conducting all forms of "distance supervision"
- Set boundaries, ground rules and guidelines for behaviour at the start
- Be more detailed and explicit than in face-to-face supervision
- Provide reassurance within these
- Be more pro-active and interventionist and lead-taking than in face-to-face

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Exercise

Which THREE elements of Internet Supervision will you incorporate into your practice from today?

What is the biggest obstacle you experience in your use of internet supervision?

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Group Supervision

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Group Supervision Survey

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Fundamentals of Group Supervision

- The group must perceive the group as a group and the issue of group diversity
- The group is the supervisee (CONTENT & NON-VERBAL)
- Group supervision potentially fulfils Proctor's formative and restorative functions only
- Formative functions include (1) Experiencing and contributing to case problem solving (2) Sharing practice resources/information (3)

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Fundamentals of Group Supervision

- Restorative functions limited to (1) issues common to the group (only) as a whole and (2) A clear distinction between cathartic and problem solvable issues and the different implications for both (3) Acts as an antidote to isolation and invalidation
- Requires an exclusively facilitative style by supervisor (pros and cons)
- Requires a group skill set by supervisor
- Group supervisees can use a prescriptive, descriptive or confrontative styles

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Fundamentals of Group Supervision

Individual ambivalence towards groups
-mutuality & exchange vs fear of proximal attack-

Mutuality
Validation, "not the only one", higher levels of altruism

Attack
Exclusion and blame, invisibility of individual needs, hyper-sensitivity to territorialism, internal competitiveness

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Fundamentals of Group Supervision

Group solutions

- Desire for a "good tsar" to create safety
- The natural creation of internal hierarchy
(membership is better than exclusion)
- Group spontaneous creation of hierarchy and natural competitive rise of leaders
- Marking out individual territory
- Inclination towards agreement / collusion or group think to avoid conflict

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Peer Group Supervision
vs
Facilitated Supervision

Peer group supervision

Greater risks of conflict or collusion and loss of focus
Do rotating chairs work?
Externalising goals, rules and processes

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Ground Rules

- Group ground rules – mutual respect, contribution and commitment
- Establish the balance of group aims and commonality of content
- Establish modes of delivery
- Establishing the structure eg. agenda and broad structure
  - To be agreed at the end of the previous meeting and allocated by faciliatator
  - 15-20 mins per agenda item
  - 3-4 contributors per meeting
  - Identification of recorder

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Group Supervision
Ground Rules Guidelines (Handout)

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Exercise

Read through the Guidelines

What would you wish to change, remove or add?

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Group Formative & Restorative Functions
&
Modes of Delivery
(Handout)

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Example

Supervision Meeting
DVT Team
14 November
14.00-15.15

1. Group round of something I'm grateful for this week as a therapist (5 mins)
2. Case presentation; learning question- at what point do you discharge a non-compliant BPD client from a DBT skills training group when there are no other services to send them to? (Carole 20 mins)
3. Demonstration of two different ways of completing a hot cross bun + discussion (Jimmy 20 mins)
4. Presentation of new DVT Diversity document and round robin of issues it raises/action points (Mo 15 mins)
5. Dealing with pressure from referrers during IAPT closure (Carole 20 mins) Catharsis and problem solving

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Basic group facilitation behaviour

- Use body to model desired group arousal level
- Use revolving head and body
- Continuous eye contact
- Address and draw in each individual member

- Avoid behaviour consistent with an individual consultancy model
- Vary pacing
- Maintain momentum and draw to appropriate conclusion with good time keeping

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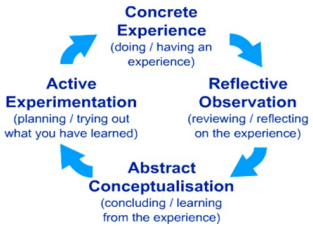
What facilitation model to use?

- State the end point or purpose of the allocated time

- Lewin-Kolb or Solution Focused model



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Lewin-Kolb Example

Facilitator: "Carole's going to raise a case regarding what point do you discharge a non-compliant BPD client from a DBT group when there are no other services to send them to. Carole-take us through the issues that have led to the question of discharge and also the issues that it raises."…….

Facilitator: " OK, what different things good, bad and indifferent cross people's mind about this situation" / "OK, lets go round and hear what different things good, bad and indifferent cross people's mind about this situation"…….

Facilitator: " OK, what strikes each person the most, regarding what's been shared……What implications has this got the next time this situation arises for each of you"……

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Demonstration

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Key points

DO

- Be very active on process
- Actively draw out each group member
- Do move the group around the Lewin-Kolb learning circle
- Do attempt to enable EACH group member to go away with a learning experience

DO NOT

- Ask the case presenter "what do you want to get out of discussing this"
- Encourage a long back story
- Try to "solve the case" although supervisee anxiety MAY be one of the issues raised
- Just address the supervisee who raises the case

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Solution Focused Example

Facilitator: "Carole's going to raise a case regarding the question of at what point do you discharge a non-compliant BPD client from a DBT group when there are no other services to send them to. Carole-take us through what you feel you have done right so far with this case."…….

Facilitator: " OK, what have other people found helpful when dealing with situations like this in the past"…….

Facilitator " OK, what do people think Carole's doing that stops things being worse than they are?"

Facilitator: " OK, lets go round and hear what different peoples thoughts are about what they'd be experiencing and doing if they had this dilemma and were dealing with it successfully"…….

Facilitator: " OK, what strikes each person the most regarding what's been shared……What implications has this got the next time this situation arises for each of you"……

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Key points

DO

- Be very active on process
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- Do move the group around the Lewin-Kolb learning circle
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- Ask the case presenter "what do you want to get out of discussing this"
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Exercise

Which THREE elements of group supervision will you incorporate into your practice from today?

What is the biggest obstacle you see in your use of group supervision?

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Supervision of Supervisors (SVoSV)

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Supervisors have little support

- ? Training as a supervisor
- Become a supervisor
- You're on your own

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Poorly researched..despite the need

Gabbay et al (1999) 82% of participating supervisors expressed dissatisfaction over their support arrangements

Milne (2009) 'the supervision of supervisors is the most deficient area in the whole enterprise of clinical supervision'

Holloway (2014)Optimal organizational system for supporting and developing supervisors has 'rarely been investigated or discussed

Bernard & Goodyear (2014) "far less attention has been paid to the development of supervisors than has been devoted to those receiving it.

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What do supervisors want from supervision survey?

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General Points

- Research is thin on the ground
- Research almost exclusively based on supervisors in training eg Milne (2009) and for supervision of trainees
- A consensus on "supervisor in training" aims is easiest question to address
- Research typically (a) uses supervision models and methods (b) is stronger on theoretical models than on practical delivery eg limitations of SAGE (2018)

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What does the research suggest ?

Ellis & Douce (2001) "Trainer" led US group for novice supervisees

5-8 supervisors, 2hr/week. 60-90 mins "supervision case" presented per week, use of taped parts of supervision session. 30-60 mins other individual issues.

Methods: role plays, role reversals, discussion, IPR.

Issues: supervisor anxiety, intervention choices, group cohesion, responsibility, parallel process, power struggles, individual differences, and sexual attraction

Wheeler & King (2000) N=70 UK Counselling Supervisors Survey, 70% satisfaction. Issues: Boundaries, supervisee competence, training, ethics

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A Way Forward….

- Supervisor needs vary according to role, context and individual request. Use triangle model to clarify
- **Normative**: Has the supervisor prescribed responsibilities regarding the supervisee? Typically formative/normative. Consider SAGE (2018)
- **Formative**: Typically interpersonal/personal rather than supervision specific. A useful SupervnOfSupvr benchmark goal to link back to issues raised
- **Restorative**: Distinguish issues requiring catharsis/validation and those requiring problem solving/learning

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A Way Forward…. (1)

- Supervisor needs vary according to (a) role, context and individual request and (b) Individual or group supervision of supervisors format

Use triangle model to clarify

- **Normative**: Has the supervisor prescribed responsibilities regarding the supervisee? Typically formative/normative. Consider SAGE (2018)
- **Formative**: Typically MORE interpersonal/personal rather than supervision specific. A useful SupervnOfSupvr benchmark goal to link back to issues raised
- **Restorative**: Distinguish issues requiring catharsis/validation and those requiring problem solving/learning

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A Way Forward…. (2)

- Supervision of Supervisors **style** variable according to supervisee experience, issue (e.g. learning new supervision methods vs stress of a difficult supervisee) and format (individual vs group)
- Establishment of regular facility more important than structure and content
- Similar principles to practicalities of supervision

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Discussion demonstration of Group SVofSV

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Exercise

Which THREE elements of supervision of supervisors will you incorporate into your practice from today?

What is the biggest obstacle you see in your use of supervision of supervisors?

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Group Functions & Modes Of Delivery

Time spent

Formative **Restorative**

Formative	**Restorative**
Individual case discussion with a universal learning point Ethical issues with a universal learning point Demonstration of technique/strategy Demonstration and discussion of a novel approach and/or novel problem Presentation of a journal article/chapter/ web site/video or policy document and discussion of its practical implications Feedback on shadowing with a universal learning point	Working alone Description of common work challenges Lack of clarity about optimal practice Management of negative feelings about clients Management of positive feelings about clients Management of confusion about appropriate action **Cathartic or Problem Solving?**
Exercise focused on "what went well"/a challenge I overcame this week with a universal learning point A piece of work I'm proud of and what I did to achieve that, with a universal learning point	

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Group Supervision Ground Rules

To be read out by the facilitator at the start of each supervision meeting

Group members are minded of the fact the rules below are in place to facilitate a successful supervision group in order that all members benefit from their participation

- All group members will aspire to, be supported to achieve and demonstrate equal commitment to supervision as shown by preparation, timeliness, attendance and active contribution to the supervision process

- All group members will demonstrate respect for other members – verbally and non-verbally- by seeking their opinions, by actively listening to and attending to them, and allowing them to talk without interruption

- All group members will demonstrate respect the expression of the opinions of other group members even when they do not value or agree with them

- All group members will recognise and abide by the authority embedded in the supervision facilitator including their right to manage and facilitate the group

- All group members will demonstrate a very high level of discretion regarding confidentiality regarding disclosure outside the group. This will not be the case in instances of risk to self and others, breaches of professional code of conduct.

- Sanctions for breaching these ground rules are as previously agreed and exercised by the group facilitator

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